

Install and First Project Setup

A short guide for installing the app, opening the sample project, and preparing your own project folder.

What to download: Download and run `GeoChem Explorer_0.2.3_x64-setup.exe`. The `latest.json` file is only for optional update checking from a shared release folder; it is not needed to install the app.

1. Install the app

1. Download the installer from the shared Google Drive folder.
2. Double-click `GeoChem Explorer_0.2.3_x64-setup.exe`.
3. If Windows SmartScreen appears, choose **More info**, then **Run anyway**, if you trust the source of the file.
4. Follow the installer prompts. The installer is set up for the current Windows user, so admin rights should usually not be required.
5. Open **GeoChem Explorer** from the Start menu or desktop shortcut.

2. First launch setup

On first launch, GeoChem Explorer asks for computer-level setup choices. These settings are separate from any individual geology project.

Setup step	Recommended choice
Updates	Choose Disable update checks on this computer unless you have been given a synced shared release folder. If you do have one, choose Check a shared release folder and add the folder that contains <code>latest.json</code> and the installer.
Default projects folder	Choose the parent folder where you want your GeoChem Explorer projects to live, for example <code>Documents\GeoChem Explorer Projects</code> . This does not need to already contain a project.
Default input source folder	Optional. Leave it unset unless your CSV files are copied from another master/source folder.
Core photo roots	Optional. Leave blank for a first demo. Add a core photo parent folder later if you use prepared core image libraries.

Click **Save Setup** when the review page looks right.

Do I need a project folder before starting?

For the sample demo: no. Click **Load Sample Project** and the app installs its bundled sample project for you.

For your own data: yes. Create one project folder per project or prospect before loading your own CSV files.

Does the app create my real project folder?

No. Create the project folder yourself, then point the app at it. The app can write project setup files and cache files inside that folder, but your source CSVs should be placed or copied there by you.

3. Run the sample project first

1. After setup, the **Project Loader** screen appears.
2. Click **Load Sample Project**.
3. Wait for the project to load, then try the main workspace: scatter plot, histogram, plan view, downhole view, filters, and analyte selectors.
4. When you are ready to set up your own data, return to **Project Inputs** from the top bar.

The sample project is also useful as a template. Its folder contains a `project.json` file and an `input` folder with example CSV names and columns.

4. Prepare your own project folder

Create a folder for the project, then create an `input` subfolder inside it. Put your CSV files in the `input` subfolder.

My Project		
project.json		optional at first; Auto-Setup can create it
input		
collar.csv		required
survey.csv		required
assays.csv		required
lithology.csv		optional
geology.csv		optional
structural.csv		optional
magnetic_susceptibility.csv		optional

The app requires collar, survey, and assay datasets. Optional datasets can be added later.

Dataset	Minimum important fields
Collar	Hole ID, X/easting, Y/northing, RL/elevation. A completed date and prospect field are useful if available.
Survey	Hole ID, depth, azimuth, dip.
Assays	Hole ID, from depth, to depth, plus assay/analyte columns such as Cu, Au, Zn, Fe, or your project-specific elements.
Lithology	Hole ID, from depth, to depth, lithology code.

5. Load your own project

1. Open the **Project Loader**.

2. If your project already has a valid `project.json`, click **Select Project Folder** and choose the project folder, not the `input` folder.
3. If this is a new project, click **Auto-Setup Project** and choose the project folder.
4. Review the detected file names and column mappings.
5. Click **Save Setup + Load Project**.

Important folder rule: Choose the main project folder. Do not select the `input` subfolder directly. The app expects to find project settings at the project folder level and data files under `input`.

6. Updating CSVs later

For normal use, replace or update the CSV files in your project `input` folder, then reload the project from **Project Inputs**.

Input Sync is optional. Use it only if your project keeps local input files copied from another master folder. Otherwise leave Input Sync blank and work directly from the project `input` folder.

Prepared for internal GeoChem Explorer distribution. For a deeper walkthrough of analysis tools and panels, use the full GeoChem Explorer User Guide.